SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

23 September 2024 · Shift 3

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 25 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 16 questions

Q.1

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. _ Y R W I Y _ X I _ R _ I Y R Z

(A) XRYY
(B) IRZY
(C) IYYX
(D) IRYY

Q.2

In a certain code language, ‘cat dog monkey’ is coded as ‘55 66 88’; ‘camel cat donkey’ is coded as ‘66 99 33’ and ‘dog goat tiger’ is coded as ‘88 11 22’. How is ‘monkey’ coded in that language?

(A) 88
(B) 66
(C) 11
(D) 55

Q.3

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 45, 52, 63, 76, 93, ?

(A) 116
(B) 118
(C) 122
(D) 112

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. MSD: NHW :: OAE : LZV :: NIP:?

(A) MQK
(B) MRK
(C) NRL
(D) NSL

Q.5

The position(s) of how many letters will remain unchanged if all the letters in the word ‘LAUNDER’ are arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) Three
(B) None
(C) Two
(D) One

Q.6

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 152 ÷ 6 + 1617 × 7 – 77 = ?

(A) 785
(B) 578
(C) 758
(D) 587

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'WJSL' is coded as '25-12-21-14' and 'DUOH' is coded as '6-23-17-10'. What is the code for 'PFKR' in the given language?

(A) 19-9-12-19
(B) 20-10-14-21
(C) 20-9-12-20
(D) 18-8-13-20

Q.8

13 is related to 21 following certain logic. Following the same logic, 35 is related to 43. To which of the following numbers is 66 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 71
(B) 73
(C) 74
(D) 72

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter cluster in the same way as the second letter cluster is related to the first letter cluster and the fourth letter cluster is related to the third letter cluster. EXPENSE : EPXEESN :: FASHION : HSAFNOI :: FORTUNE : ?

(A) TROFENU
(B) ENUTROF
(C) TUNEFOR
(D) ROFNUTE

Q.11

The question contains pairs of words that are related to each other in a certain way. Three of the following four word pairs are alike as these have the same relationship and thus form a group. Which word pair is the one that DOES NOT belong to that group? (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word.)

(A) Boxing – 1 player in a team
(B) Chess – 1 player in a team
(C) Polo – 4 players in a team
(D) Football – 10 players in a team

Q.15

Three of the following number-pairs are alike in some manner and hence form a group. Which number-pair does not belong to that group? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 12 – 156
(B) 21 – 462
(C) 14 – 196
(D) 17 – 306

Q.16

Which two numbers (not digits) should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 6 × 3 + 8 ÷ 2 + 21 + 5 × 4 – 14 ÷ 7 = 53

(A) 8 and 4
(B) 3 and 5
(C) 21 and 14
(D) 2 and 4

Q.17

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the given sets. (6, 31) (10, 91) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) (7, 68)
(B) (8, 57)
(C) (12, 146)
(D) (9, 81)

Q.20

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will logically complete the series. ME_ICM_DIC_GDI_MHD_C

(A) DEMAI
(B) DFMCI
(C) DCFMI
(D) DFMBI

Q.24

21 is related to 220 by certain logic. Following the same logic, 72 is related to 781. To which of the following is 27 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 340
(B) 286
(C) 290
(D) 316

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'A & B' means ' A is the brother of B', 'A x B' means 'A is the father of B', 'A ? B' means 'A is the mother of B' and 'A ! B' means 'A is the wife of B'. Which of the following means that W is the mother's mother of P?

(A) W & R ! Y x O ? P
(B) W ? R x Y ! O & P
(C) W ? R ! Y & O x P
(D) W ! R x Y ? O & P

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Digestion of food is an important function of the animal body. In animals like lions, cows, humans, etc., the process involves use of various organs starting from the mouth and ending with the anus. The longest part of this canal is known as the _____.

(A) small intestine
(B) stomach
(C) oesophagus
(D) large intestine

Q.2

Who among the following is known as 'Captain Cool' in Indian Cricket?

(A) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(B) Kapil Dev
(C) Virat Kohli
(D) Sachin Tendulkar

Q.3

Papanasam Ramayya Sivan was an Indian composer of which music style?

(A) Bhajan
(B) Folk music
(C) Qawwali
(D) Carnatic music

Q.4

Which of the following is a difference between self-help groups (SHGs) and microfinance institutions (MFIs) in India?

(A) SHGs provide only credit, while MFIs provide a range of financial services.

(B) SHGs rely on government subsidies for funding, while MFIs rely on commercial sources of funding.

(C) SHGs are typically small, community-based organisations, while MFIs are larger and more formal institutions.

(D) SHGs are non-profit organisations, while MFIs are for-profit organisations.

Q.5

Which famous experiment was done by Michael Faraday in 1831?

(A) Discovery of law of elasticity

(B) Discovery of electromagnetic induction

(C) Discovery of quantum magnetometers

(D) Discovery of natural radioactivity

Q.6

The book 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' was written by _____.

(A) Bipin Chandra Pal

(B) MN Roy

(C) Dadabhai Naoroji

(D) Lala Lajpat Rai

Q.7

Where was the first meeting of the Employment Working Group of G20 conducted?

(A) Jaipur

(B) Kolkata

(C) Jodhpur

(D) Lucknow

Q.8

In which of the following states is the Chu-Faat dance performed?

(A) West Bengal

(B) Sikkim

(C) Uttarakhand

(D) Haryana

Q.9

What is the salinity of the Dead Sea (per litre of water)?

(A) 340 grams

(B) 390 grams

(C) 440 grams

(D) 240 grams

Q.10

Which of the following is the first Indian woman Grandmaster in Chess?

(A) Tania Sachdev

(B) S Vijayalakshmi

(C) Harika Dronavalli

(D) R Vaishali

Q.11

Who reconciled Dalton's atomic hypothesis with Gay-Lussac's results on the combination of volumes in 1811?

(A) Robert Boyle

(B) Fred Hoyle

(C) Jacques Charles

(D) Amadeo Avogadro

Q.12

As per the Census of India 2011, the increase in literacy rates for males and females, respectively, as compared to 2001 Census was:

(A) 4.88% and 10.79%

(B) 5.88% and 12.79%

(C) 6.88% and 11.79%

(D) 3.88% and 13.79%

Q.13
Which of the following is a festival primarily celebrated in the state of Odisha?

(A) Chhath
(B) Raja Parba
(C) Me-Dam-Me-Phi
(D) Baishagu

Q.14
Which Act was passed by the British Parliament in the year 1773 AD to regulate the activities of the East India Company?

(A) Pitt's India Act
(B) Age of Consent Act
(C) Indian Slavery Act
(D) Regulating Act

Q.16
The famous santoor player Pandit Shivkumar Sharma received the _____ in the year 1986.

(A) Sanskriti Award
(B) Kalidas Samman
(C) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
(D) Maharashtra Gurav Puraskar

Q.17
The Aryans lived in the land known as 'Sapta Sindhu' (Land of the Seven Rivers). Which of the following was NOT a part of it?

(A) Ravi
(B) Shipra
(C) Jhelum
(D) Indus

Q.18
Who was the chief coordinator for the G20 summit hosted by India?

(A) S Jaishankar
(B) Vijay Gokhale
(C) Vinay Kwatra
(D) Harsh Vardhan Shringla

Q.19
Who among the following founded the Pala dynasty in 8th Century CE?

(A) Dharmapala
(B) Gopala
(C) Devapala
(D) Ramapala

Q.20
The ICAR – Sugarcane Breeding Institute is located at:

(A) Cuddalore
(B) Coimbatore
(C) Tirunelveli
(D) Vellore

Q.21
Who assumed charge as the new Vice Chief of the Indian Navy on 31 July 2021?

(A) Ravneet Singh
(B) Karambir Singh
(C) SN Ghormade
(D) Dinesh K Tripathi

Q.22
The number of ministers, including the Chief Minister, in a state shall NOT be less than _____.

(A) 13
(B) 12
(C) 11
(D) 10

Q.23
_____ Directive principles of State Policy were added to the Indian Constitution by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976.

(A) Three
(B) Four
(C) Five
(D) Two

Q.24

Who published the logistic equation model of population growth in 1838?

(A) Alfred Russel Wallace
(B) Howard Thomas Odum
(C) George Evelyn Hutchinson
(D) Pierre François Verhulst

Q.25

Which of the following is NOT a major climate control of a place?

(A) Interior of the earth
(B) Ocean currents
(C) Latitude
(D) Altitude

Quantitative Aptitude 10 questions

Q.1

In a team of seven members, the average age of six of the members is 42 years while the age of the seventh member of the team is 36 years more than the average age of all the seven members taken together. Find the age (in years) of the seventh member of the team.

(A) 84
(B) 78
(C) 80
(D) 90

Q.3

If in a circle a chord of length 14 cm is at a distance of 24 cm from its centre, then the length of the radius of the circle is:

(A) 28 cm
(B) 25 cm
(C) 24 cm
(D) 31 cm

Q.9

A boat covers a distance of 55 km downstream in 5 hours while it takes 11 hours to cover the same distance upstream. What is the speed of the boat?

(A) 8 km/h
(B) 11 km/h
(C) 7 km/h
(D) 9 km/h

Q.10

A class of 30 students appeared in a test. The average score of 12 students is 62, and that of the rest is 60. What is the average score of the class?

(A) 60.8
(B) 59.8
(C) 58.8
(D) 61.8

Q.12

The ratio of the ages of A and B, 3 years ago, was 5 : 7. The ratio of their ages, 13 years from now, will be 9 : 11. If the present age of C is 11 years less than that of B, then the present age of C, in years, is:

(A) 31
(B) 20
(C) 23
(D) 36

Q.14

In ΔPQR, if $4\angle P = 5\angle Q = 20\angle R$, then the value of $\angle Q$ is:

(A) 45°
(B) 90°
(C) 36°
(D) 72°

Q.15

If an employee's income is ₹72,000, the amount he spends is 40% higher than his savings. Therefore, his savings (in ₹) is:

(A) 30000
(B) 32000
(C) 34000
(D) 28000

Q.17

The number 4,29,714 is divisible by:

(A) 6 and 5
(B) 3 and 6
(C) 4 and 6
(D) 3 and 5

Q.21

The single discount equivalent to a series discount of 60%, 70% and 80%.

(A) 95.5%
(B) 85%
(C) 70%
(D) 97.6%

Q.24

A customer pays ₹975 in instalments. The payment is done each month ₹5 less than the previous month. If the first instalment is ₹100, how much time will be taken to pay the entire amount?

(A) 26 months
(B) 14 months
(C) 27 months
(D) 15 months

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The “cynical” investors believed in every word the analysts said.

(A) persuasive
(B) credible
(C) distrustful
(D) credulous

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Her remarks were “relevant” to the discussion.

(A) Suitable
(B) Inappropriate
(C) Conclusive
(D) Introductory

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Lethargic

(A) Active
(B) Angry
(C) Languid
(D) Moderate

Q.4

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Select the option that arranges the parts in the correct sequence to form a meaningful sentence. (P) unlock their potential (Q) empowers individuals to (O) and shape their future (R) the power of education

(A) QROP
(B) RPOQ
(C) RQPO
(D) OPRQ

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Athens was suffering under the rule of “a powerful small group” that had no concern for the people's welfare.

(A) an oligarchy
(B) a monarchy
(C) a missionary
(D) a democracy

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. Ranjith failed in all his exams “as he had been addicted of” social media.

(A) as he had been addicted to
(B) as he had been addicted at
(C) as he had been addicted on
(D) as he had been addicted in

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the incorrectly spelt word in the following sentence. I doubt that these lifts can acommodate 100 people.

(A) accommodate
(B) acomodate
(C) accomodate
(D) accommodatte

Q.8

Select the sentence that is expressed in passive voice.

(A) Children are participating in sand-art competition.
(B) I prefer tea to coffee.
(C) She sketches beautifully.
(D) The consignment was delivered yesterday.

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The evening time when the sun has just set and it is almost dark.

(A) Night
(B) Dusk
(C) Dawn
(D) Day break

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Dodge

(A) Force
(B) Boarding
(C) Avoid
(D) Amount

Q.11

Select the option with the correct use of future tense.

(A) By next December, I will be completed six years in this home.
(B) By next December, I will have been completed six years in this home.
(C) By next December, I will have complete six years in this home.
(D) By next December, I will have completed six years in this home.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the following sentence. The teammates made several “jibes” at the opponent team members during the interview.

(A) Inspiration
(B) Contradict
(C) Consolation
(D) Mockery

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. This year’s budget is unlikely to pass as law since the president’s proposed budgets typically face a “jaundiced eye” but this one has gotten even more scepticism.

(A) Jealousy
(B) Good will
(C) Confidence
(D) Resentment

Q.14

Select the correct spelling to fill in the blank. I often fail to _____ remember someone's name.

(A) acusatively
(B) accurately
(C) accuratially
(D) accuriately

Q.15

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Mr. Suman / asked me / to pack / my luggages.

(A) my luggages.
(B) to pack
(C) Mr. Suman
(D) asked me

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Her behaviour was so "ostentatious" that it attracted the attention of everyone in the room.

(A) Gentle
(B) Restrained
(C) Repulsive
(D) Attractive

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the following sentence in passive voice. The baker baked the cake.

(A) The cake had been baked by the baker.
(B) The cake has been baked by the baker.
(C) The baker has been baking the cake.
(D) The cake was baked by the baker

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place to park aeroplanes

(A) Hanger
(B) Shed
(C) Hangar
(D) Depot

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Dissipate

(A) Malicious
(B) Haste
(C) Glorious
(D) Spend

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. Sejal visits the nearby temple "off and on".

(A) Periodically
(B) Constantly
(C) Regularly
(D) Continuously

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Human Development Index (HDI) is a summary (1) _____ of average accomplishment in important areas of human development, (2) _____ living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living. The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised (3) _____ for each dimension. The health component is (4) _____ by life expectancy at birth, while the education dimension is measured by the average number of years of schooling for individuals aged 25 and above, as well as the (5) _____ number of years of schooling for school-age children.

Select the most appropriate answer for blank number 1.

(A) collect
(B) involvement
(C) assessment
(D) regiment

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Human Development Index (HDI) is a summary (1) _____ of average accomplishment in important areas of human development, (2) _____ living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living. The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised (3) _____ for each dimension. The health component is (4) _____ by life expectancy at birth, while the education dimension is measured by the average number of years of schooling for individuals aged 25 and above, as well as the (5) _____ number of years of schooling for school-age children.

Select the most appropriate answer for blank number 2.

(A) including
(B) manifesting
(C) exaggerating
(D) segregating

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Human Development Index (HDI) is a summary (1) _____ of average accomplishment in important areas of human development, (2) _____ living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living. The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised (3) _____ for each dimension. The health component is (4) _____ by life expectancy at birth, while the education dimension is measured by the average number of years of schooling for individuals aged 25 and above, as well as the (5) _____ number of years of schooling for school-age children.

Select the most appropriate answer for blank number 3.

(A) contents
(B) indices
(C) glimpses
(D) features

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Human Development Index (HDI) is a summary (1) _____ of average accomplishment in important areas of human development, (2) _____ living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living. The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised (3) _____ for each dimension. The health component is (4) _____ by life expectancy at birth, while the education dimension is measured by the average number of years of schooling for individuals aged 25 and above, as well as the (5) _____ number of years of schooling for school-age children.

Select the most appropriate answer for blank number 4.

(A) levitated
(B) measured
(C) escaped
(D) triggered

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Human Development Index (HDI) is a summary (1) _____ of average accomplishment in important areas of human development, (2) _____ living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living. The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised (3) _____ for each dimension. The health component is (4) _____ by life expectancy at birth, while the education dimension is measured by the average number of years of schooling for individuals aged 25 and above, as well as the (5) _____ number of years of schooling for school-age children.

Select the most appropriate answer for blank number 5.

(A) accompanied
(B) hypnotised
(C) neglected
(D) predicted

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**		

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) IRYY

With I, R, Y, Y in the blanks the series is IYRW IYRX IYRY IYRZ: IYR, followed by W, X, Y and Z in turn.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 55

'cat' is in the first two phrases and '66' in the first two codes, so cat = 66; 'dog' is in the first and third, as is '88', so dog = 88. That leaves monkey = 55.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 112

The differences are consecutive prime numbers: 7, 11, 13, 17. The next is 19: 93 + 19 = 112.

Q.4 · Answer (B) MRK

Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (their places add up to 27): M ↔ N, S ↔ H, D ↔ W and O ↔ L, A ↔ Z, E ↔ V. So NIP → MRK.

Q.5 · Answer (B) None

LAUNDER in alphabetical order is A D E L N R U. Compared place by place with L A U N D E R, no letter stays where it was.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 758

After interchanging the signs: 152 × 6 – 1617 ÷ 7 + 77 = 912 – 231 + 77 = 758.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 18-8-13-20

Each letter is coded as its place in the alphabet plus 2: W (23) → 25, J (10) → 12, S (19) → 21, L (12) → 14. So P, F, K, R (16, 6, 11, 18) → 18-8-13-20.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 74

The second number is the first plus 8: 13 + 8 = 21 and 35 + 8 = 43. Likewise 66 + 8 = 74.

Q.10 · Answer (A) TROFENU

The first four letters are reversed, then the last three: EXPE|NSE → EPXE|ESN and FASH|ION → HSAF|NOI. So FORT|UNE → TROF|ENU: TROFENU.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Football – 10 players in a team

Polo is played four a side, and boxing and chess one against one. A football team has 11 players, not 10, so that pair does not belong.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 14 – 196

In 12 – 156, 21 – 462 and 17 – 306 the second number is the first times the next number (12 × 13, 21 × 22, 17 × 18). 14 – 196 is 14 × 14, so it is the odd one.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 21 and 14

Interchanging 21 and 14: 6 × 3 + 8 ÷ 2 + 14 + 5 × 4 – 21 ÷ 7 = 18 + 4 + 14 + 20 – 3 = 53.

Q.17 · Answer (B) (8, 57)

The second number is the square of the first, minus the first, plus 1: $6^2 – 6 + 1 = 31$ and $10^2 – 10 + 1 = 91$. Likewise $8^2 – 8 + 1 = 57$.

Q.20 · Answer (B) DFMCI

With D, F, M, C, I in the blanks the series is MEDIC MFDIC MGDIC MHDIC: M, then E, F, G and H in turn, then DIC.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 286

The second number is 11 times one less than the first: 20 × 11 = 220 and 71 × 11 = 781. Likewise 26 × 11 = 286.

Q.25 · Answer (D) W ! R x Y ? O & P

W is R's wife and R is Y's father, so W is Y's mother. Y is O's mother and O is P's brother, so Y is P's mother: W is P's mother's mother.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) small intestine

The small intestine is the longest part of the alimentary canal; much of digestion and absorption takes place there.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Mahendra Singh Dhoni

Mahendra Singh Dhoni is called 'Captain Cool' for his calm captaincy.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Carnatic music

Papanasam Sivan was a composer of Carnatic music, mostly in Tamil, and is sometimes called the 'Tamil Thyagaraja'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) SHGs are typically small, community-based organisations, while MFIs are larger and more formal institutions.

Self-help groups are small, informal groups, usually of 10 to 20 people from one community, who pool their savings and lend to one another; microfinance institutions are larger, formally registered lenders.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Discovery of electromagnetic induction

In 1831 Michael Faraday discovered electromagnetic induction: a changing magnetic field produces a current in a nearby conductor.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Dadabhai Naoroji

Dadabhai Naoroji's 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' (1901) set out his drain theory: that British rule was draining India's wealth.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Jodhpur

The first G20 Employment Working Group meeting of India's presidency was held in Jodhpur, Rajasthan, on 2 to 4 February 2023.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Sikkim

Chu-Faat is a Lepcha dance of Sikkim, performed in honour of Mount Khangchendzonga and its neighbouring peaks, with the dancers carrying butter lamps.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 340 grams

SSC's key gives 340 grams, the figure usually quoted for the Dead Sea (a salinity of about 34%, nearly ten times the ocean's). NCERT's geography textbook gives a lower figure, 238 parts per thousand, close to the 240 grams option, so the answer depends on the source.

Q.10 · Answer (B) S Vijayalakshmi

SSC's key gives S Vijayalakshmi, India's first Woman Grandmaster (WGM, the women's title). The open Grandmaster title was first won by an Indian woman in 2002, by Koneru Humpy, who is not among the options; Harika Dronavalli and R Vaishali won it later.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Amadeo Avogadro

In 1811 Amedeo Avogadro proposed that equal volumes of gases at the same temperature and pressure hold equal numbers of molecules, reconciling Dalton's atoms with Gay-Lussac's law of combining volumes.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 6.88% and 11.79%

Census 2011 put literacy at 82.14% for males and 65.46% for females, against 75.26% and 53.67% in 2001: rises of 6.88 and 11.79 percentage points.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Raja Parba

Raja Parba, a three-day festival in mid-June celebrating womanhood and the earth, belongs to Odisha. Chhath is mainly Bihar's; Me-Dam-Me-Phi (Ahom) and Baishagu (Bodo) are Assam's.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Regulating Act
The Regulating Act of 1773 was the British Parliament's first step to control the East India Company; it created the post of Governor-General of Bengal. Pitt's India Act followed in 1784.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1986; the Padma Shri (1991) and the Padma Vibhushan (2001) followed.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Shipra
Sapta Sindhu, the Rig Vedic land of seven rivers, lay in the north-west: the Indus and its Punjab tributaries such as the Jhelum and the Ravi, with the Saraswati. The Shipra flows in Madhya Pradesh, past Ujjain.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Harsh Vardhan Shringla
Former Foreign Secretary Harsh Vardhan Shringla was India's Chief G20 Coordinator for its 2023 presidency.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Gopala
Gopala, elected king in Bengal around 750 CE, founded the Pala dynasty; Dharmapala and Devapala were his successors.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Coimbatore
The ICAR-Sugarcane Breeding Institute is at Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu.

Q.21 · Answer (C) SN Ghormade
Vice Admiral SN Ghormade took over as Vice Chief of the Naval Staff on 31 July 2021, succeeding Vice Admiral G Ashok Kumar.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 12
Under Article 164(1A), added by the 91st Amendment (2003), a state's council of ministers, Chief Minister included, may not exceed 15% of the Assembly's strength and may not be fewer than 12.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Four
The 42nd Amendment added four Directive Principles: healthy development of children (Article 39(f)), equal justice and free legal aid (39A), workers' participation in management (43A) and protection of the environment (48A).

Q.24 · Answer (D) Pierre François Verhulst
Pierre François Verhulst published the logistic equation in 1838: a population grows ever more slowly as it nears its environment's carrying capacity.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Interior of the earth
The major controls of a place's climate are latitude, altitude, pressure and winds, distance from the sea, ocean currents and relief. The earth's interior is not one of them.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (A) 84
Let the average of all seven be A. Then $7A = 6 \times 42 + (A + 36)$, so $6A = 288$ and $A = 48$. The seventh member is $48 + 36 = 84$.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 25 cm
The perpendicular from the centre bisects the chord, so $r = \sqrt{(7^2 + 24^2)} = \sqrt{625} = 25$ cm.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 8 km/h
Downstream speed = 55/5 = 11 km/h and upstream speed = 55/11 = 5 km/h. The boat's speed is their average: (11 + 5)/2 = 8 km/h.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 60.8
$(12 \times 62 + 18 \times 60)/30 = (744 + 1{,}080)/30 = 1{,}824/30 = 60.8$.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 20
Let A − 3 = 5k and B − 3 = 7k. Then (5k + 16)/(7k + 16) = 9/11, so 55k + 176 = 63k + 144 and k = 4. B = 31, so C = 31 − 11 = 20.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 72°
Let $4\angle P = 5\angle Q = 20\angle R = k$. Then k/4 + k/5 + k/20 = k/2 = 180°, so k = 360° and $\angle Q = 360°/5 = 72°$.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 30000
Spending is 1.4 times the savings, so the income is 2.4 times the savings: 72,000/2.4 = ₹30,000.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 3 and 6
The digit sum, 4 + 2 + 9 + 7 + 1 + 4 = 27, is divisible by 3, and the number is even, so it is divisible by 3 and by 6. It does not end in 0 or 5, and its last two digits, 14, are not divisible by 4.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 97.6%
After the three discounts 0.4 × 0.3 × 0.2 = 0.024 of the price is left: a single discount of 97.6%.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 15 months
The instalments form an AP 100, 95, 90, ...: $n/2 \times [200 - 5(n - 1)] = 975$ gives $n^2 - 41n + 390 = 0$, so n = 15 or 26. At 26 months the last instalments would be negative, so the debt is paid in 15 months.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) credulous
Investors who believed every word the analysts said were 'credulous', too ready to believe. 'Cynical' and 'distrustful' mean the opposite.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Inappropriate
'Relevant' means connected with the matter and fitting; of the options, its opposite is 'inappropriate'. 'Suitable' is close to a synonym.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Active
'Lethargic' means sluggish and lacking energy; its opposite is 'active'. 'Languid' is a synonym.

Q.4 · Answer (C) RQPO
'The power of education (R) empowers individuals to (Q) unlock their potential (P) and shape their future (O).'

Q.5 · Answer (A) an oligarchy
Rule by a small powerful group is an 'oligarchy'; a monarchy is rule by a king or queen, and a democracy rule by the people.

Q.6 · Answer (A) as he had been addicted to
One is 'addicted to' something: 'as he had been addicted to social media'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) accommodate
The correct spelling is 'accommodate', with a double 'c' and a double 'm'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) The consignment was delivered yesterday.
'Was delivered' is 'was' + past participle, with the thing acted on as the subject: the passive. The other three sentences are active.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Dusk
Dusk is the darkening part of the evening just after sunset; dawn and daybreak come at the start of the day.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Avoid
To 'dodge' something is to evade or 'avoid' it.

Q.11 · Answer (D) By next December, I will have completed six years in this home.
An action that will be finished by a time in the future takes the future perfect, 'will have' + past participle: 'will have completed'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Contradict
SSC's key gives 'contradict', the opposite of the verb 'jibe', to agree or be consistent ('his story does not jibe with the facts'). Here, though, 'jibes' is a noun meaning mocking remarks, whose opposite would be praise; 'mockery' is a synonym.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Resentment
To view something with 'a jaundiced eye' is to regard it with bitterness and suspicion, as the 'scepticism' later in the sentence confirms; of the options, 'resentment' is closest. 'Jaundiced' can also suggest envy, but the sentence is about distrust, not jealousy.

Q.14 · Answer (B) accurately
The correct spelling is 'accurately'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) my luggages.
'Luggage' is uncountable and has no plural: 'my luggage'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Restrained
'Ostentatious' means showy, meant to attract notice; its opposite is 'restrained'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) The cake was baked by the baker
The simple past 'baked' becomes 'was baked': 'The cake was baked by the baker.'

Q.18 · Answer (C) Hangar
A 'hangar' is a building where aircraft are kept; a 'hanger' is for hanging clothes.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Spend
To 'dissipate' money or energy is to spend it, usually wastefully; the word also means to scatter.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Periodically
'Off and on' means now and then, at intervals: 'periodically'. 'Constantly' and 'continuously' mean without a break, and 'regularly' at fixed intervals.

Q.21 · Answer (C) assessment
The HDI is 'a summary assessment', a single measure, of average achievement.

Q.22 · Answer (A) including
The three areas follow as a list: 'including living a long and healthy life, being informed and having a good quality of living'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) indices
The HDI is the geometric mean of the normalised 'indices' (plural of 'index') for the three dimensions.

Q.24 · Answer (B) measured
The health component is 'measured' by life expectancy at birth, just as the education dimension 'is measured by' years of schooling.

Q.25 · Answer (D) predicted
Besides the average schooling of adults, the index uses the 'predicted' (expected) years of schooling for school-age children.

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